

How to Give Your Gas Grill a Deep Clean

By: Chaz Wilke - Staff Writer



Imagine a warm summer day. You catch a glimpse of that telltale wisp of smoke slowly rising into the crystal blue sky from a grill sitting on a homeowner's deck. Jealous neighbors look on longingly as they instantly recognize the unmistakable smell of seared meat and the faint sound of sizzling steaks. Children play in the yard as the pup digs through the garbage looking for a few delicious scraps.

It's hard to think of a care in the world when grilling on days like this.

But without proper care, your grill could become a serious risk to operate. If not given a deep clean each year, the accumulated grease could lead to an uncontrollable fire or even an explosion. This is something that no one wants to worry about on those perfect summer afternoons.

It's clear everyone would agree that cleaning your grill is important, but we know how easily someone can put off the laborious task weekend after weekend. After all, that grease adds flavor, right?

Whatever benefits you may think building up grease in your grill affords, it is vastly outweighed by the risks of a grease fire. Grease fires are uncontrollable, hot-burning fires that you should never attempt to extinguish with water (<http://bit.ly/1GJcgKG>). Compounding that risk is the propane tank sitting just below the grilling surface. And with that you have a recipe for a nightmare.

An advertisement for Solar Me Home. It features a family of four (a mother, father, and two children) smiling in front of a house with solar panels. The text reads: "Electricity bill too high? GO SOLAR Find Installers! Your Zip Code GO". The Solar Me Home logo is in the top right corner.

(<https://solarmehome.com/?cid=28806>)

An advertisement for Pursue Mortgage. It features a family of four (a mother, father, and two children) walking in front of a house. The text reads: "pursuemortgage Thinking About Refinancing? Find Lenders Now". The Pursue Mortgage logo is in the top right corner.

(<https://pursuemortgage.com/?cid=28806>)



To prevent fire hazards, we recommend supplementing your normal cleaning schedule with a deep clean once per grilling season. The first item on your checklist for your annual cleaning is to check for propane leaks. The National Fire Protection Association recommends a simple soapy water spray test, "Apply a light soap and water solution to the hose. A propane leak will release bubbles (<http://bit.ly/1pJR2Hx>)." If you find bubbles with your test, shut off your grill and gas tank and get your grill serviced.

Deep cleaning the grilling surface



With regular use, the grilling surface may accumulate charred bits of meat, poultry and fish, so this area needs regular cleaning. You should scrub down your grill grates with a stainless steel brush every time you fire up your grill. Let the grill preheat until it is nice and hot, and then scrub the grilling surface with your brush. Any remaining food bits will incinerate and should come off with ease.

Once a season, those grates will need a deep cleaning. Doing so may be significantly less work than you might imagine. There are a few simple and unconventional cleaning methods that require items you may already have in your home.

Laundry Detergent

Laundry detergent is great at cutting through grease and grime. Use a shallow cooking sheet with a ¾ inch or higher lip and fill it with water and a few splashes of laundry detergent. Use your finger to swish around the mixture and rest your grill grates in the solution. If you have larger grill grates, you may use the bathtub to sit them in, but be sure to place a bath towel under the grates to protect the basin of your tub from scratches.

Let the grates sit in the mixture overnight.

The next morning the grease and grit of stuck on food should wipe right off. Rinse off the grates thoroughly and let them air dry. This is a great non-toxic method of cutting through some serious stuck on grime. I've personally used this method and can confirm its effectiveness.

FreeScore360
with your 7-day Trial
& a monthly rebill of \$29.95

**Click Here
to get started!**

(<https://secure.rspcdn.com/xpr/red/PID/3569/SID>)

Your Home Windows

Replace
Or
Repair

Affordable Price

GET FREE
ESTIMATE

www.ewindowquotes.com

(9nl.it/replaceorrepair)

Rental Kharma

**BUILD YOUR
CREDIT WITH
YOUR RENT
PAYMENTS**

GET
STARTED
NOW

- ✓ Easy Registration
- ✓ Get Credit for Past Rent
- ✓ Money Back Guarantee
- ✓ 3 minute sign up

(<https://secure.rspcdn.com/xpr/red/PID/3960/SID>)
AffiliateReferenceID=hl101)

Related Articles

Ammonia

Tracy on madefrompinterest.net suggests you seal your grill grates in a garbage bag with a small amount of ammonia overnight. [Positive results \(http://bit.ly/11cfRRe\)](http://bit.ly/11cfRRe) are undeniable, but keep the sealed bag away from pets, children and grass or plants as any escaping fumes are toxic. Also remember to wear goggles, a facemask and gloves when removing the grate from the bag. If you choose to use this method, be sure to do it in a well-ventilated area.

A Can of Coke

Also on the madefrompinterest.net post, a commenter mentions that a can of Coke may be equally as effective as ammonia when applied the same way. Tie a garbage bag air tight with your grates and the contents from a can of Coke and let it sit overnight.

Vinegar and Baking Soda

Consider using vinegar and baking soda as an environmentally conscious grill grate cleaning solution. The folks over at eHow recommend the foaming mixture for your deep cleaning needs. Mary Ylisela, an eHow contributor, explains "Mix equal parts of [white vinegar and baking soda \(http://bit.ly/1GJcD84\)](http://bit.ly/1GJcD84) in a bucket or bowl, then wipe the solution onto the grill grate with a clean cloth or sponge."

It's best to do your scrubbing outside. The mixture and the gunk coming off the grates will likely get everywhere.

A great mid-season cleaning idea that is relatively unconventional is to rub [half an onion \(http://bit.ly/1xdOCTI\)](http://bit.ly/1xdOCTI) cut-side down on a hot grill surface, then treat the grates with olive oil, much as you would when seasoning a butcher block prep table. Simply apply some oil to a microfiber cloth and coat the grates. Make you're your grill is off and has had a chance to cool down. Treating your grates with olive oil may make food less likely to stick the next time you grill, and it helps prevent rusting.

Cleaning the inside of the grill lid

Now that the grill grates are positively sparkling, turn your attention to an oft forgotten part of your grill: the inside of the grill lid.

What may first appear like peeling paint is a buildup of carbon and grease that just happens to resemble an aging paint job. Kevin Kolman of Weber Nation stresses, "[It ain't paint \(http://bit.ly/1wMbw39\)](http://bit.ly/1wMbw39)." These pesky flakes can fall on your food while cooking and taint what might have been a perfect bite of BBQ.

Kolman suggests you first use your grill brush to scrub with a simple back and forth motion, then "spray the interior of the lid with the Weber Grate Grill Cleaner which will break down the remaining grease in no time. Let this cleaner sit on the lid for 30 seconds before wiping away with a damp paper towel."

Clearing the burner tube holes

When giving your gas grill a deep clean it is important to ensure each hole on your burner tubes is clear. Usually, the holes clog when various cooking residues build up on the burner tubes over time.

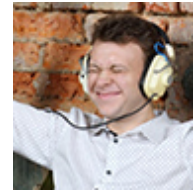
At a minimum, clogged holes will create a cold spot on your grilling surface or even keep your grill from reaching temperatures hot enough to sear a steak. The simplest cleaning method is to poke a toothpick through each burner tube hole. You may also use a stainless steel grill brush and scrub side to side perpendicular to the direction of the tube.

Takeaway



(<http://homeliving101.com/lifestyle/get-off-my-lawn-epic-neighbor-feuds-and-how-to-avoid-them/>)

We all dream of finding the perfect home. We obsess over the number of bedrooms, being close to good schools, and a nice view.



(<http://homeliving101.com/hl-trends/absolutely-obsolete/>)

Few things are permanent in this disposable culture of ours. But it's still hard to believe how quickly to-



(<http://homeliving101.com/lifestyle/trimming-the-fringe-of-suburbia/>)

There is no more potent image of American prosperity than a sprawling tree-lined street filled with large single-family homes. In a word: suburbia - born...



With regular maintenance your grill will last many years. Avoiding maintenance will cost you performance and temperature consistency when grilling. A dirty grill can lead to potentially dangerous situations when grease is allowed to build up year after year. Respect your grill, treat it well and look forward to year after year of trusty use and delicious food!

Chaz Wilke is an employee of Deka Marketing Group. Deka Marketing Group receives payment from advertisers on HomeLiving101.

Home Living 101 is owned and operated by Deka Marketing Group. The information provided on Home Living 101 is provided for informational purposes only. The operator of this website assumes no responsibility or liability for any actions taken as a result of using this website, and/or for errors or omissions in content. When you link to any third party website and/or article provided via this website, you are leaving our website. We make no representations as to the information provided at third party websites and/or third party privacy practices. Please consult with your own independent legal advisor before relying or acting on any information provided on this website and/or a third party.